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Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/53059834.

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A Favorite Place

by WitchBitchAddi

Summary

Catra shows up to an old apartment for a second date.

Notes

Content warnings for
- drug use (weed)
- alcohol use
- me being sappy in the end note

This work is specifically a birthday gift :)

See the end of the work for more notes

Catra stood outside of the old brick apartment building, just off of Logan Street, toward the southside. It had clearly been standing since at least the ‘70s, the original bright red having faded to a dull brown and gray. The mortar was chipping off of most of the front, lichen spotted the surface, and great english ivy crept up to the third story windows in places. The buzzer was ancient as well, and she hesitated to press it, not just because of the likelihood of it not working, but also because of the giant bundle of nerves that rested in her stomach.

Going over to someone’s place was usually at least a fourth or fifth date for Catra — or a first, if she didn’t plan on ever seeing them again. Nonetheless, she found herself at the address the girl had given her, silently willing herself to either turn around and leave or to press the damn button.

It’s not that the first date had been bad; actually, it had been really lovely (otherwise she wouldn’t have agreed to a second date). It was more that she didn’t really know the woman. They’d only had about forty-five minutes in a hole-in-the-wall coffee shop that Catra knew as a safe spot for first meetings, but most people just called the Lunar Glow. Catra hadn’t said much, but — in all fairness — she rarely found herself in a talkative mood. The blonde had dominated the conversation — ideal for Catra — with a lot of gossip involving people Catra had never met. While it made for a fun conversation, the date hadn’t really informed Catra much about the woman in any substance.

She knew that the blonde worked at a music store, she knew that she liked cats (a lot — especially orange cats), and she knew that her name was Adora Bright. That was it.

Well… she also knew that Adora was insanely attractive. Aside from the obvious (her well-muscled arms and shoulders, the elegant curve of her face, her startling blue eyes, the fact that she was a full head taller than Catra) there was a certain air of nonchalance and confidence that put Catra at ease almost instantly. This was unusual, as those traits usually scared the hell

out of Catra. But something about the way Adora laughed had warmed Catra's face and chest. She had all these quirks — in the way she spoke, in the way she moved, in the way she interacted with strangers, and how different her interaction with Catra had been — these little things made Catra feel alarmingly comfortable.

And, perhaps worst of all, it had brought her to Adora's front door.

Catra stared down the buzzer. Finally, sucking in a deep breath through her teeth, she jabbed the nub with her pointer finger. The low *bzzzzzz* crackled through the intercom uncomfortably and warped. Adora's voice did not ring from the speaker, and Catra raised her hand to buzz again when the door lock clicked. She tried the door. It opened. She stepped inside, every muscle tense with anticipation. Rolling her shoulders and neck she relaxed slightly, and then she began the trek up four flights of stairs to apartment 417.

Yet again Catra was face to face with a door that she wasn't really sure she wanted to open. She pushed down her anxiety and knocked.

No response.

She knocked again.

Silence.

And then: — right as she was about to turn around and say "fuck it" to this whole escapade — "Come in! The doors open!"

All things considered, she felt it more than a bit strange that the woman didn't even bother to come to the door. But she had already walked all this way from the metro stop, and Adora had promised a bit of food, and she was starving. So she walked inside the apartment.

The first thing Catra noticed was how horrible the use of space was. To her right was the kitchen (if it could really be called that): just a counter, a stove top, a sink, and an oven, with some wood cabinets overhead that clearly hadn't been replaced since the building was constructed. There was no division between that space and the rest of the room. To her left was the TV, and directly in front of her, splitting the room entirely in half, was a massive couch. A few bean-bags filled up the space between the TV and couch that wasn't taken by the low coffee table. There was no table and no chairs. Opposite the doorway she stood in was another door currently ajar, and what seemed like a bedroom lay beyond it. Adora was nowhere in sight.

The second thing Catra noticed was how adorable the decorations were. Stuffed animals littered the sitting area, and a giant blue and white shark took up half of the couch. Posters for various bands Catra had never heard of were stuck up on the wall. There was no overhead lighting — instead bright green string lights lit up the whole living space. It was clearly a well-loved place. A white board hung on the wall next to the sink, with little doodles and words scrawled across every inch of it. Most of the messages seemed to be greetings from various friends, and at least half of the drawings were of little cats. Catra was actually envious of the atmosphere. Her landlord didn't allow any real modifications to her living space, which felt much more like a hotel room than an actual apartment.

Catra realized she was just standing in the entryway with the door wide open, and quickly shut it behind her. And then realized she wasn't really sure what to do next. It felt weird to step further into the apartment uninvited. Thankfully Adora appeared in the doorway from the bedroom.

She was wearing tight skinny jeans and a white shoulderless blouse with a floral pattern snaking up from the hem. Her entire outfit seemed specifically chosen to perfectly show off every muscle, and her collar bones were doing something strange to Catra's stomach.

“Hey, you look nice.” Adora’s voice struck lightning across Catra’s vision.

Catra managed to choke out a similar response, and found her throat was suddenly quite dry. She stared at the blonde woman for a few moments, completely unaware of her surroundings. Adora did not move either, her eyes wandering up and down Catra. The two stayed like that for a moment, each just staring at each other, and Catra suddenly became acutely aware of how awkward the moment was. Adora definitely realized she’d been staring.

A sharp beeping shook the two out of the moment, and Adora sprung to action, quickly disabling the timer with one hand and turning off the burner with another. Simultaneously she waved Catra further into the apartment, telling her to take a seat on the couch. Still feeling a bit awkward, but a little charmed, Catra sat down on the sofa, sitting sideways and craning her head around to still look at the blonde. Adora moved to the oven, and on inspecting whatever was inside gave a satisfied hum and grabbed some oven mitts.

The food safely out of the oven, and nothing else in the kitchen within imminent risk of spontaneous combustion, she began taking plates down from the cabinets. Adora was fully blocking whatever she was doing with the food, but she was giving Catra a wonderful view of her back. Her revealed shoulder muscles rippled with every calculated movement she made, drying up Catra’s mouth again, and working strange magic in her insides.

To occupy herself, Catra picked up her couch neighbor — the giant blue and white shark — and fidgeted with it a bit, giving it a cautious squeeze. It was extremely soft and good to hold, and she understood why Adora must keep the thing as the centerpiece of this cozy space.

Finally Adora seemed to have finished, and she turned around with a giant smile, her eyes beaming with pride.

“Dinner’s ready!”

Catra flashed a small smile in response as Adora gathered the two plates, some silverware, and two glasses of wine, all of which she precariously managed to fit into her arms. She made her way extremely slowly over to the couch, staring intently at the two wine glasses being held in her left hand to ensure that nothing spilled. She reached the coffee table, and then realized that she had no way to place anything down without dropping a different item. Her gaze flashed to Catra’s with a silent plea for help, and Catra obliged, standing to gently take the two wine glasses and place them on the table.

With the food laid out in front of her, Catra was able to see Adora’s handiwork. She had cooked some mashed potatoes and steak, the aromas filling her nose. She realized again just how hungry she was when her stomach gurgled unpleasantly. The food itself had been arranged neatly and meticulously, a garnish of some unidentified leaf of some sort atop the potatoes. She sat back on the couch, not wanting to be rude by digging into it. Adora was talking — Catra realized with a start that she had been talking for quite some time — about the spice rub. Something about coffee grounds and balsamic vinegar letting the meat soak… or something. She felt a pang of guilt for not paying more attention, but to her credit, it was very difficult to listen to what Adora was actually saying when her voice sounded like that. Plus the food looked absolutely to-die-for. She was distracted. And hungry.

Adora must have noticed the glazed-over look on Catra’s face, because she suddenly thrust a fork and serrated knife into Catra’s hands and told her to try the food. Now having been invited, Catra eagerly dug into the decadent meal. It was incredible. Half of her plate was finished before she even paused to look up. Adora had taken a few bites, but she was staring directly at Catra expectantly.

Not really knowing what to say Catra smiled again, and then, realizing that wasn’t enough, finally opened her mouth to say

something.

“It’s really really good. Thank you.”

Adora smiled brightly. “Of course! I’ve been prepping since last night. I wanted it to be absolutely perfect for you, especially after I bragged so much about my steak when I saw you last!”

Had she mentioned that? Catra reached into her memory for anything and came up empty handed. Whatever, she wasn’t about to complain about her current situation. The woman of her dreams was sitting almost suffocatingly close to her on the couch. The couch that was in her apartment. That Catra was in. For a date.

Her brain reeling, and her stomach feeling quite full, Catra fell back into the cushions, unconsciously holding the shark closer to her.

Adora brightened. “Oh! You like Strawberry!”

Catra looked at the blonde confused for a second before piecing together that she was referring to the shark. Despite herself she snorted a bit trying to stifle a giggle. “You named him Strawberry?”

“Yeah! Don’t they look like a Strawberry?”

Catra gazed deeply into the embroidered eyes of the creature, studying every inch of it before deciding — “No, that’s a dumb name. I love them.”

Adora laughed sweetly and loudly and Catra’s stomach tensed at the sound. “I just thought it would be a cute name for them. I’ve had them for, like, four years now. They’re my favorite.” She paused and looked at the other stuffed creatures. Then, with her voice lowered, said “but don’t tell the others that, as far as they know I love them all equally.” She had a conspiratory grin stretching across her gorgeous stupid face, and was leaning way too close to Catra for Catra to really breathe.

Despite herself, Catra found herself playing the dumb game. She sat up straight, and held out her little finger. “I am sworn to secrecy. They will never know.”

Adora grabbed Catra’s finger with her own and they shook on it. Their touch lingered for a moment, despite the joke being firmly over, and Catra realized that she was staring directly into Adora’s eyes. And that Adora was meeting her gaze perfectly. Electricity buzzed through the whole room, dancing at the edge of Catra’s vision, and with a start she snatched her hand back. If Adora was hurt or startled by the movement, she didn’t show it. She barely moved, still staring directly at Catra, and the buzzing only got louder. Catra realized that the tips of her ears, her cheeks, and her nose were extremely warm.

Finally — mercifully — Adora broke her gaze and stood up suddenly.

“Come on, we’ve got somewhere to be!” She held out her hand to help Catra up.

Catra was certain that if she took the blonde’s hand she would fully pass out, and after a moment Adora took the hint and grabbed Catra’s empty plate (and her own half-empty plate) instead. Somehow the blonde’s wine glass was empty, and as Adora placed the dishes in the sink, Catra gulped it down quickly, allowing the taste to shock her senses back to reality. She shook her head quickly and stood up.

“Uh… we do?”

Adora, surprisingly, didn’t answer. She did give a very sly grin, and strode over to the pantry. Opening it, she grabbed two skateboards.

“Do you know how to ride?”
Catra bit back her first thought, nodded, then amended: “It’s been a while but I think I could pick it up quick enough.”
“Cool. Because it’s more fun to skate there.”

“And where exactly is ‘there’?”

“Oh you’ll see. C’mon, just trust me!”

Catra’s blood ran cold. Trust was the one thing she did not give easily, and — though the dinner had been incredible, and was certainly a boon in the trust department — Adora was still basically a stranger.

Still. It was just skateboarding.

Catra deflected. “Did you pull not one but two skateboards out of a… food pantry?”

“Yes. And don’t deflect. You up for an adventure?”

Catra sighed. Fuck it. Why not. Might as well see where this led.

Adora did a little bounce of victory accompanied with a fist pump, which Catra found entirely too adorable for her own good, and then Adora picked up a small green backpack that was positioned next to the door. She slid into a cute pink leather jacket, then slung the backpack over her shoulder, handed one of the boards to Catra, opened the door to the apartment, and then held her hand out to Catra. “You coming?”

Catra bit back another joke. “Yes dumbass, I’m right behind you.” She still took the blonde’s hand. As soon as she made contact with her, Catra simultaneously found herself relaxing slightly and tensing up. Her stomach tied itself into a tight knot, and her heart felt like it was trying to escape her chest with its pounding, but she suddenly had no questions about following the woman. She was fully on board for whatever was about to happen. She wasn’t entirely sure what was happening, and she was still recovering from the shock she’d had two days prior when Adora had texted her asking if she’d wanted to come over to her apartment for dinner. Of course she’d agreed, but the fact that Adora had even wanted to see Catra a second time was more than she’d been expecting. She wasn’t exactly the best at making conversation.

The semi-cool night air slapped Catra in the face as Adora opened the front door of the complex. Somehow they'd made it down all the stairs it seemed. She realized her hand was still firmly in the other woman's, which sent shivers down her spine. Thankfully, the blonde let go as their shoes hit the asphalt, and she dropped her board to the ground. Catra followed suit and stepped onto the deck. Her platform boots probably were not the best riding shoes, but she would have to make-do. Adora immediately pushed off, and Catra realized that she was riding goofy. Of course she was: the blonde seemed to do everything the unique way.

After the initial shock, and finding her balance in the boots (and having to bail several times in rapid succession, much to her embarrassment), Catra found herself riding smoothly. The two rolled down the street Catra had walked up less than an hour before, turning right instead of left, away from the direction of the metro. As she glided along, Catra closed her eyes momentarily, breathing in the fresh air, reveling in the moment. This was the happiest she had been in quite some time. She hadn't done anything just for the sake of it in a long time, and she suddenly felt like a teenager again. Wild and free. Her chest lept into her throat and she nearly threw herself from her board as anxiety gripped her lungs. This was Adora. This was how Adora made her feel. This was dangerous.

The last time she'd felt like this…

Adora was laughing wildly. They were heading downhill and rapidly picking up speed. The woman's blonde hair was streaming behind her, and the streetlights made her look like she was shimmering. She looked back at Catra, and her gaze somehow reassured Catra. The anxiety was still there, but Catra realized she could push it away somewhat. Adora held out her left hand, gesturing for Catra to catch up. Catra gave a few powerful pushes until she was parallel with Adora. The wind whipped through her curly hair, almost certainly causing it to frizz. Her lungs were tight both with nerves and exertion, but her mind was clear, and her heart felt lighter than the air whirling around her. And then the blonde snatched Catra's hand. She was vaguely aware that her

face was likely bright red, but she didn't let go. Adora raised their joint hands up and hollered into the night. Catra's chest fluttered and for a moment she completely forgot that she was barreling down an actual road. For a moment the entire universe collapsed around the two of them, and it was just Catra staring at Adora.

Then Adora leaned to the right and the two started carving down the street in unison, still hand in hand. They took a right, then a left, and Adora broke away, carving harder to slow down as they approached a large dark building. She turned into the parking lot in front of the building, and Catra followed, passing by a brick signboard barely illuminated by dying bulbs that read "Stonewall Middle" at the entrance to the lot. Adora stopped by first carving a few circles, then jumping off and kicking the board into her hands, the wheels still spinning. Catra did not stop so elegantly, instead doing her best to brake with her boot, then attempting to mirror Adora's elegant carve, losing her balance and bailing, and then chasing after her board that finally lost its momentum in the grass that separated the lot from the large glass front doors.

Adora was doubled over catching her breath while trying to stifle giggles, and Catra found herself laughing as well with euphoria. The night was cloudy, but the moonlight still illuminated enough to see everything clearly despite the lack of unnatural light.

When Catra finally got her laughter under control, and her breathing stabilized enough, she asked "Why are we at some middle school a mile from your apartment?"

Adora tossed her skateboard under some bushes in the front lawn, effectively hiding it. "I used to go here."

"Cool, thanks for answering the question." Realizing that her tone might have been slightly harsh, she hastily continued. "So you just wanted to show me some place you went, like, fifteen years ago?"

Adora only winked, then held her hand out to Catra.

Sighing deeply, and making a very conscious decision to let go of her anxiety as best as possible, Catra stowed her borrowed board in the same place, and took Adora's hand. "You know you're really bad at answering questions, right?"

Adora giggled but didn't give her the benefit of a response.

Catra allowed herself to be guided by the blonde around the back of the school. Into the dark. If it wasn't for the fact that Adora didn't really seem like she could hurt a fly, Catra would have assumed she was about to be murdered. With a start she realized she was trusting the woman not to murder her, and Catra found herself doing mental calculations as to the chances of an attempt on her life.

Adora stopped in front of a seemingly random wall of the school, and let go of Catra's hand. Despite herself she felt a sudden pang of absence with Adora's warmth gone.

Without turning around Adora took a running start at the brick of the side of the school, leaping into the air at the last moment. She pressed her right foot against the wall, launching off of it midair to gain a bit of extra height, and reached her arms as far as they would stretch, just barely catching the lip of the flat roof.

Catra was entirely rooted in place by the sudden feat of athleticism. The blonde managed to do a pullup and, using a U-mount off of a nearby gutter as leverage with her left foot, she rolled fully on top of the building. Her face reappeared above her.

"Hey Catra." Adora's face was completely unreadable, but her gaze and words still made Catra turn bright red. She just hoped Adora couldn't see it very well in the darkness.

"Hi." She was embarrassed by how shy she sounded in her reply.

"Don't worry, you don't have to do what I did. The mounts holding the drainage pipe to the wall are really strong, you can just climb up that. And I'll help pull you up."

So, despite her instincts, Catra started climbing. The things she did for pretty women.

When she was high enough up the pipe, Adora grabbed one of her wrists and helped pull her on top of the flat roof.

"So what now?" Catra asked, suddenly very aware that she was at least fifteen feet above ground-level.

Adora pointed to the top of the three-story building. "We go up there."

Catra groaned, but, when Adora started jogging across the roof toward a service ladder, she realized she had no choice but to follow.

There was no ladder that led to the third level from the second. But Adora had clearly done this before. And Catra had decided to maybe give this trust thing a second try. Catra followed behind the other woman as they made their way across, but did not follow suit when Adora broke into another sprint. The blonde reached the edge of the building, and, with Catra giving a cry of concern behind her, she launched herself into the air, clearing a gap to another section of roof that was slightly taller than the section Catra stood on. Adora caught herself on the side of the other section, doing another pull up to get back to stable ground. The two sections were separated by the part of the building that was three stories tall, the part Adora now stood on at essentially a right angle to the part that Catra stood on.

Either Catra had to do the same and jump across the gap, or she had to carefully step upward around the corner of the three-story section, hanging dangerously over a two story drop. She froze. She was not ready for this.

Adora was looking at her expectantly, her head tilted to the side curiously. "Do you need help?"

Catra took a large gulp of air and focused all of her brain on trying not to throw up from nerves. "Yes. Please."

“Okay. So don’t jump. Instead, just come to this corner here. If you reach around there’s a little lip — see? — that you can put your foot on. And then it’s just an easy step up to here. Right?”

Catra was at the edge, and making the horrible mistake of looking down. She felt dizzy. “Right.”

“Here look, I’ll be right here the whole time. You’ll be fine.”

Despite her brain screaming at her not to do it, Catra nodded, and reached a foot around the corner. She felt the foothold, and stepped out, reaching her right arm around the corner as well until she found a handhold. Then she slowly, carefully, with every move calculated, moved her left foot off of the relative safety of the other roof. She was now held up entirely by her right foot and hand. She slowly brought her left foot and body around the obstacle, leaving her left hand to firmly grasp the corner. She could at the very least now see where she was going. The lip she was standing on was no more than a few centimeters jutting out from the wall — a misplaced brick, that at the very least was not moving. Her destination was the other roof of the building, at about hip level presently. She just had to transfer her left foot to the lip, and then step up. She did this even slower than she had at first, glancing over to her goal. Adora was leaning over the edge, her hands hovering at the small of Catra’s back, but not quite touching. Catra stepped upward with her right foot, and started carefully shifting her weight. She let go with her left hand in order to reach better, and leaned down to the side to grasp the ledge with her right hand.

And then, despite her best efforts, she slipped.

Her heart dropped out of her body as her right foot slipped, and she felt the sudden rush of air as she began to fall. At least eight meters to the ground.

But the ground wasn’t getting any closer. She looked up and saw Adora’s face smiling down at her, her right arm grasped firmly in both of Adora’s hands.

“Told you I got you.”

Catra felt like she was about to sob, and her right shoulder felt unpleasantly stressed. With some miracle Adora managed to haul Catra over the ledge and onto the safety of the building’s roof.

“Almost lost you there.”

Catra did not answer. Instead she just lay on her back staring up at the sky. That was close. Without fully having any control over it, she burst out laughing. She laughed until her sides hurt, until tears were streaming down her face. She realized with a start that she was crying and laughing at the same time. Adora was laying next to her, still holding her hand with her left, and the blonde began laughing too.

When she finally managed to stop laughing she hungrily gulped down the fresh air, before turning her head to look at Adora. “Thanks for saving my life, asshole.”

“Oh it was nothing. I said I had you, I wasn’t about to let you die. Plus, wouldn’t that be a really shitty way to end a date?”

“Oh absolutely. I much prefer my dates to end with all parties alive and well.”

“You doing alright? You scared of heights or something?”

“Oh, I’m downright terrified,” Catra responded with a huge grin.

“Well, we’re almost to the top — and no more scary maneuvering this time. There’s a ladder right over there.”

Sure enough, another service ladder led to the top of the third story. Catra shrugged. At this point it didn’t matter. Three meters or twelve, it was still way too high for comfort. But she was so far out of her comfort zone at this point that she actually wanted to be higher up. So she stood up before Adora, and sprinted toward the ladder, laughing the whole way. “What are you waiting for, dummy? This was your whole idea.”

Adora pushed herself to her feet and ran after Catra, scaling the ladder after her. When the two had reached the top, Catra allowed Adora to take the lead, and Adora led her to a little alcove that had a service hatch in the floor.

"This is one of my favorite spots in the whole world." The blonde sat down against the concrete wall of the alcove and looked up.

Catra did the same. The clouds had begun to clear, and in the spots not so close to the nearly-full moon, she could clearly see stars. It was beautiful. Below them stretched a significant portion of the city, the highrises glittering in the distance. It was a beautiful view. "Are all of your favorite spots insanely dangerous to get to?"

The other woman grinned softly, then muttered, "I think you'll just have to find out." She had slid her backpack off of her shoulders, and was reaching into it. She pulled out two beer bottles and handed one to Catra — though on closer inspection they turned out to be spiked lemonade. After taking a sip from hers, Adora reached back into her bag and pulled out a suspiciously cone-shaped cigarette and a lighter. "I forgot to ask if you smoked," Adora said after lighting and taking a long draw, slowly exhaling the smoke, and closing her eyes slightly.

"Very very occasionally. Mostly when someone offers," Catra said, taking the joint and a hit for herself.

She let her eyes slide halfway closed as well, allowing the lights from the city and the moon to shoot bright beams up and down across her vision as they blurred. She passed the joint back to Adora and took a sip from her own lemonade. "I can see why you like it up here."

Adora responded with a content "mmmhmmm," and slid her right hand into Catra's left.

Catra let it happen. And she barely blushed this time.

The two sat in silence for a long while, just passing the joint back and forth slowly, allowing much of it to burn down on its own. As the pleasant buzz of the weed hit Catra's nerves, she felt her anxiety lift from her body and take flight. For the first time that night (well, realistically for the first time in weeks) she felt completely calm. With no fear, she allowed her head to slide down, coming to a rest on Adora's shoulder. Adora rested her head on Catra's and murmured something Catra couldn't make out. She didn't bother asking what she'd missed. Adora pulled out her phone and pressed play on her music, allowing some nostalgic 2010's alternative indie rock to fill Catra's eardrums softly. It was barely audible, and it just put Catra more at ease.

Though barely audible, Catra recognized one of the songs. "Hey wait, is this Car Seat Headrest?"

"Yeah."

"You *would* listen to them."

"And you know them well enough to recognize decade-old songs."

"Shut up."

"You shut up."

"No you shut up."

"No, *you* shush."

Both of them were smiling widely. It was a small joint, but they were both still extremely high, and ever so slightly crossed as well from the spiked lemonade.

"Why don't you make me?" Catra said it gently, barely loud enough for the sound to even reach her own ears. She was certain Adora didn't hear her.

But then Adora's hand was on Catra's cheek, gently turning her head to face her gaze. Catra found herself staring into Adora's deep blue eyes, and realized she didn't know how to breathe. Adora was slightly taller, even sitting, and Catra's face was angled upward ever so slightly, Adora's fingers now holding Catra's chin. Adora was studying her face intensely. Her gaze wandered from Catra's eyes down to her lips.

Adora raised an eyebrow in question. Catra was still trying to understand how to get air from outside into her lungs, and failing at doing so. She wasn't thinking about much. Or anything. Anything except Adora.

The scent of her perfume filled Catra's nostrils (she'd managed to breathe!) and her eyes fluttered shut for a moment. When she opened them Adora was still looking at her with questioning in her eyes.

"Make you shut up?" Adora murmured gently, her face close enough that each word brushed gentle bursts of hot air across Catra's lips. Catra almost moaned. Her heart was tight with anticipation, and she pressed her chin ever so slightly downward in a sort of nod.

Adora seemed to get the hint and leaned in even closer. Her lips were nearly brushing Catra's at this point, and Catra's lips sang with static electricity and the heat from Adora's nearness. "It seems like you're already pretty quiet."

Catra wanted nothing more than for the pretty woman to just press her lips against her own. And for the life of her she couldn't figure out why that wasn't already happening. Except that maybe Adora was toying with her.

But that would be mean. Adora wouldn't be mean, would she?

Adora was, in fact, seemingly very mean, as another agonizing second passed without her lips against Catra's.

The ball was in Catra’s court, and she had no choice. So, quietly, barely a murmur, she replied. “What are you waiting for, princess?”

Finally having the affirmative that Catra was absolutely one-hundred-percent okay with this, Adora closed the last centimeter of distance, and gently pressed her lips to Catra’s.

Catra sighed with happiness as her eyes fluttered fully shut, and her mind melted with the rush of endorphins that exploded into her brain. The tangle of emotions filled her entire body and she sighed directly into Adora’s mouth, their closed lips slowly working around each other.

Catra and Adora kissed each other gently, softly, taking all the time in the world. Every hitch of each other's breath fed the other, and sustained the kiss for what felt like hours. When they finally broke away from each other, and Catra’s eyes slid open again, she saw that Adora’s pupils were entirely blown out, the size of dinner plates. She was certain her own eyes mirrored Adora’s.

They looked at each other for a moment, and then, Catra realized that she deeply *deeply* missed the feeling of Adora’s lips on her own. Without thinking she grabbed Adora’s head in her hands, one hand cupping the back of her head, the other cupping her cheek and neck, and pulled herself back into Adora’s embrace. Adora wrapped her arms around Catra and pulled her in tighter.

Their lips met again, this time clashing. While that first kiss had been gentle and slow, this one was bordering on violent. Catra wanted to taste all of Adora. She bit Adora’s lower lip and was rewarded with a low growl from Adora’s chest. Adora pushed back harder, kissing Catra even deeper, flicking her tongue gently and deftly to meet Catra’s. A sound Catra did not recognize ripped itself from her throat in satisfaction.

Adora pressed harder, and Catra was forced to lean backward. Suddenly Adora’s hands were on her lower back and head, lowering her onto the ground.

Then Adora broke away, and Catra actually whined. It was pitiful. Pathetic. Embarrassing. She needed Adora so badly. Catra was actually going insane over this girl. Adora ripped her jacket off of her, and balled it up, thrusting it behind Catra. Then she grabbed Catra again and kissed her even harder.

Catra swore she had not taken a breath in at least five minutes, and Adora was slowly lowering her down again, this time onto the relative comfort of the makeshift pillow. Who needed oxygen anyway. Adora was more important. The blonde was running her hands over every inch of Catra's nearly bare back, her touch raising goosebumps beneath the thin lace that was frustratingly stopping them from having direct skin-to-skin contact. Catra's breathing was heavy, and every single motion that Adora made was electricity.

What she was experiencing was less "sparks" and more "full lightning storm".

Adora broke away from their kiss again, leaving Catra's lips thoroughly beaten up. Instead of fully departing, Adora planted a kiss on Catra's cheek. Then her jawline. Then just below her jawline. She worked her way down to the crook of her neck, almost on her shoulder. Her tongue darted out with every kiss, barely grazing Catra's vein. Catra moaned again, louder than she meant to. Then Adora bit down, and Catra had to stop herself from screaming with relief. Adora bit and kissed and teased. She moved on to the next spot, slightly higher on Catra's neck. She toyed with the soft skin, breathing in and tasting the bitterness of Catra's perfume. Nothing stopped her though as she slowly tortured Catra.

Finally, agonizingly, thankfully, Adora pulled away, panting. The bigger woman daintily wiped at her mouth. Catra collapsed back onto the concrete, allowing her head to fall fully into the soft jacket. She realized she had been arching her back: pressing upward into Adora.

Catra was breathing heavily. She stared up into the sky, the lights slightly blurry, her vision swimming ever so slightly.

She suddenly realized that she was still quite crossed, as well as entirely beat from the best kissing she'd experienced in years (or maybe her entire life).

Adora collapsed down next to Catra, propping her own head up with her arm. "Hi." She sounded almost shy.

Catra managed to slow her breathing enough to respond. "Hey, Adora."

Adora smiled, leaned in and kissed Catra gently on the forehead. "Lay on me for a bit?"

Catra nodded, and propped herself up. Adora adjusted so that she could lie fully on the jacket, and let her right arm unfurl outward. Catra lay down on Adora's shoulder, and Adora wrapped her outstretched arm inward protectively around Catra's shoulders. Both were on their backs, staring up at the stars.

Once again the two were silent. The joint had long since gone out, and Catra's drink was empty. Adora's still had some in it, but she didn't seem to have any particular interest in finishing it at that moment. The moon had moved quite a bit, and Catra realized with a start just how long they had been up there.

After several minutes Catra became acutely aware of the cold. Despite it being a fairly warm summer night, she had not been prepared for an extended stay outdoors. She shivered slightly, and Adora lifted her head slightly.

"A little chilly?"

Catra nodded in affirmation.

"Okay, let's head back then."

Catra thought for a second. She really didn't want the night to end, and fear tore at her heart — her anxiety rushing back into her — as she realized that as soon as they were off the roof this date would be over.

Adora seemed to sense her hesitation, and quickly followed up with, "We can watch a show or something on my couch. Night doesn't have to be over yet, yeah?"

With that reassurance, Catra's anxiety slipped back to the dark place where it lived. She nodded softly.

Adora gently untangled herself from Catra, sat up, and finished off her bottle of lemonade. She slowly clambered to her feet, stretching as she did. Catra lied there for a second, watching the gorgeous woman do her stretches, a few joints popping as she did so. Still very dazed and fully blissed out, Catra stood up and dusted herself off. She shivered into a slight gust of wind, her ripped stockings and short-shorts doing little in the way of wind-stoppage. Adora repacked her little backpack with the empty bottles, and placed the half-smoked joint into a little plastic sealed tube. She took out a water bottle and gulped down a few greedy mouthfuls, before passing it to Catra. Catra took a small sip, realized how much she needed water, and then did the same as Adora before passing it back.

The pair made their way back down the ladder. Adora made a running leap and jumped the same gap, this time landing fully on the other roof.

Then Catra realized she had to do the same thing.

And she was crossed.

Panic suddenly swept into her chest again. There was no way she was taking the same route back across. Not after nearly slipping and plummeting to at the very least a very painful trip to the hospital. There was only one real way back across the gap: the same way Adora had cleared it.

“You can do it Catra!” Adora waved from the other roof, which suddenly felt lightyears away.

It was only a meter gap at best, probably less. Catra knew she could make it. It was just a matter of doing it.

What if she slipped? What if she tripped? What if it was actually way further than it looked and she didn’t make it? What if there was a sudden earthquake and the other roof moved?

She shook her head to clear her thoughts.

She had to do this.

And hey, she’d get bonus points for impressing the girl, right?

“You’ve got this! I’ve got you, just like last time, I won’t let you fall, okay?”

Catra nodded.

She took a deep breath, and a few steps backward.

And then she started running.

She ran straight toward the gap.

She was seconds away from the edge of her roof.

She reached the edge, sprang forward, and squeezed her eyes shut.

And then she was flying. She opened her eyes for a moment. And she really felt like she was flying. Adora was below her, watching her, eyes wide. Catra realized she was screaming, but suddenly she wasn’t sure if it was from fear or excitement. She thought for a moment that she would just keep going up up up, into the sky, never having to touch the ground again.

Then the other roof began to rush upward to meet her.

Agonizing moments stretched for hours, and then her feet touched the concrete on the other side.

She landed neatly, her legs bending to absorb the impact.

And there was Adora, steading her, then crushing her in a giant hug. “You did it!”

Catra looked up at Adora, and before she could stop herself she said, “Did I impress the girl?”

Adora smiled bigger than Catra had ever seen her smile before. “Sure did.” And then she kissed Catra.

It was quick, just a second. But it was full on the lips, and Catra was melting again. She let herself go weak and relied on Adora for support. Electricity arced across her brain as their lips connected, and when Adora pulled away her lips were still burning.

They made the rest of the way down uneventfully. Adora lowered herself slightly off the roof and then jumped away, rolling to break her fall. Despite Catra’s initial protests, Catra got down by lowering herself and then dropping into Adora’s arms. Any thought of protest or embarrassment evaporated as soon as Adora’s arms were surrounding her.

The two walked back to the apartment hand in hand, their skateboards in their off hands. Catra was tired and didn’t talk much. Adora talked quite a bit, just about anything. This time Catra didn’t mind at all. The sound of Adora’s voice warmed her heart completely.

When they finally made it back to the apartment, Catra was almost falling over herself in exhaustion. She brightened up at the re-instated suggestion of watching a show. Adora said she’d been watching this really cute cartoon about witches, and Catra was happy to watch whatever Adora wanted her to watch. They finished the rest of the joint outside, on the steps of the apartment, before heading in.

When they got back inside the apartment Adora guided Catra over to the couch, then disappeared into the bedroom for a moment. She reemerged with two blankets and yet another large blue and white shark.

"This one is named Rasberry," Adora informed Catra very helpfully. Catra nodded in complete understanding, already holding Strawberry in her arms. Adora joined her on the couch, and pulled the blanket over both of them. Catra settled herself onto Adora's chest as Adora turned on the TV and set up the show.

As Catra's eyelids drooped, and she began the long process of slowly blinking, trying desperately to keep her eyes open, she was dimly aware that Adora's arms were fully wrapped around her, pressing Catra into her chest. She heard Adora murmur, "I think I found my new favorite place."

Catra didn't wasn't awake enough to respond, but her chest bloomed with warmth, and she snuggled even deeper into Adora's arms.

The last thing Catra remembered from that night was a very weird talking owl-tube-thing and a kiss on the forehead from Adora before her vision faded entirely into darkness.

End Notes

Hey Jayla :)
I love you lots.
Happy birthday <3
Here's to a much better year than the last, yeah?
I've always got you - just like you've got me, remember that.

Please drop by the Archive and comment to let the creator know if you enjoyed their work!